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Dear Admission Committee,

REF: RECOMMENDATION FOR SAMUEL GARIY OTIENO

My first interaction with Samuel was through a piece of writing. I was grading essays for the school's essay writing competition and his on the current political state of our country, Kenya was insightful yet humorous. I was surprised to learn that he was only in his first year at the time yet his language use revealed a wildly intelligent young mind with a startlingly clear perception of issues. This was all confirmed when I finally interacted with him as a club patron and later as his teacher of English Language and Literature for his final year of high school.

During his third year of high school, after a careful selection process, he was selected as part of the team to represent the school in the World Scholars Cup competition. At the outset, he appeared reserved because of his calm demeanor that stood out among his peers. This notion was however soon dispelled as he came out as the most active member of the lot. He was the paradoxical joker who still made useful contributions that turned even the dullest of research topics a joy not only for the team but also for me as their patron. As a result, he was unanimously appointed captain by his team members. He led his team through the East Africa regional round all the way to the International round in Bangkok where they were feted as among the best teams in essay writing and debates.

During my English and Literature lessons, Samuel was an invaluable asset. First, his inclination towards the language coupled with his high comprehension skills, ensured his grades for the subject were always high. Samuel was what I would call, 'passionately curious' and this love for research made the class vibrant. His approach availed questions in grammar and writing that encouraged class discussions to arrive at conclusions. This improved the class's performance as a whole.

I have taught a number of students in my career spanning over twenty years and Samuel is among the few that will truly be remembered. His unmatched love for books stands tops. It is no surprise that in the final term of his final year he took part in an internal book drive to collect books for a Non-governmental organization, *The Hands Movement*. Despite the busy schedule considering he was preparing for his final National examinations, he was able to find time to take part in this project. This resulted in more children getting access to books and a proper education which is a joy he believes no one should be denied.

Samuel teaches as much as he learns. Over the years, I have picked a lot from the young man. His humility despite his impressive intellect is one. His selflessness to assist his peers is an impressive trait for a young man his age. He was the best performer in my English class and his desk mate, ironically the worst. However, Samuel painstakingly assisted his friend to improve his English grades. He would submit extra work they had both worked on for marking thus being a constant feature in the department offices. When his friend's final grade improved from a D to a B, so happy was I that I baked a cake to celebrate

the feat with the department and the two boys. Small in itself, this victory served to remind me the reason why I became a teacher in the first place.

I would be delighted to go on and on if I had the chance. The fact remains that Samuel is a special student whose absence will be direly felt in the school. His personality, values and passion left a long-lasting impact on the school and the lives of students and all those who interacted with him. It is with this in mind that I strongly recommend him to your institution for admission, where he is bound to make an even bigger impact.

Yours sincerely,



Evelyn A Kibisu

Head of Department,

English Language and Literature.